

Outline

Thesis: College is an important next step to extend my learning experiences and advance in my chosen career path.

I. Reason for Attending

A. Learning

B. Money

C. Job Security

II. Contributing Factors

A. Family

B. Where to attend

1. East Tennessee State University

2. Northeast State Technical Community College

C. Cost of attending

D. Transferring credits

III. Reflecting on my Decision

A. Classes

B. College environment

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Why I Am Attending College

As I am the first in my family to attend college, I am very thankful to have come this far. I am looking forward to advancing and challenging myself to learn and become better at the skills I do. The decision to go to college was a good one to make, but there was a lot of contemplating where to go and what degree to pursue. College is an important next step in my life to extend my learning experiences and advance myself in my chosen career path.

The primary reason I want to attend college is to be able to learn. In the fast paced world of information technology, there is always something new to learn, no matter how much one may already know. I also enjoy learning about the world in general. In learning about the world around, one can learn about oneself. I enjoy exploring new ideas and concepts. The great philosopher Socrates once said, "The unexamined life is not worth living."

Many other factors contributed into my decision of attending college. I want to be financially secure when I am older. Many studies show that people with a college degree make more money in their lifetime than non-graduates. It has also been shown that a person with a college degree is more likely to be hired for the job than a person with only a high school diploma. This is essential for me because of the competitive field of information technology. I not only want to obtain a well paying job, but I want to secure my position within the company. I also want to be able to have a job in which I am interested in the work I am performing.

My decision to go to college was a decision that was made by me. I had always been told throughout middle and high school that college was very important to complete if I wanted to succeed. My family has always pushed for me to go to college because they never did attend

college. Although my family expected me to go to college, it was a decision I made for myself based on my needs.

I had to decide where to attend college. With so many options, my decision was hard to come by. I made the decision long before that I wanted to stay near home, so my choices were very limited. I narrowed my choices down to either East Tennessee State University or Northeast State Technical Community College. I discussed with friends on what their plans were for college. I had heard from many people that ETSU had a very good information technology program, yet I already had a short amount of credit hours established at Northeast State. After reaching a conclusion, I applied to ETSU and was accepted.

I considered the cost of attending each school. Financial aid would only pay for half of what I could get if I attended Northeast State because it is a two year school, versus receiving full financial aid for attending ETSU. I already has established a small amount of credit hours at Northeast State from taking proficiency tests of the classes. My original plan was to attend Northeast State for two years and then transfer to ETSU and finish out my remaining credits. After researching, however, I found out that many credits that I would want to transfer would not be transferable because of class type mismatches. After reaching my conclusion, I applied to ETSU and was accepted.

Now that I am in college, I feel as if I have made the right decision. Classes are becoming smoother, and I am beginning to settle into the environment. Though the work is now picking up, I am managing my time efficiently and getting assignments completed on time. I enjoy the atmosphere on the campus, too. Unlike high school where people are very judgmental, college is more of an open environment to explore new ideas and allows an individual to choose what to believe rather than force someone. As as entering freshman, college is going well and can only get better.

College is the next step for me. It is important so that I may advance in my chosen field as well as to challenge myself. I want to have job security and financial stability in the future, all

of which college can help to bring. Though my choices were broad, I was able to narrow my choices and make a decision to meet my needs. My choice of going to college will not be one that I will regret.